

# **Local Demographic and Language Programming Report**

*Demographic Insights Across Reading Cinemas' Nine  
Victorian Locations*

## **Audience Profile, Cultural Catchment Analysis & Film Programming Opportunities**

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## **Executive Summary**

Reading Cinemas' nine Victorian locations operate within different local audience catchments, and each cinema serves communities with different population sizes, age profiles, household types, cultural backgrounds and languages spoken at home. A single programming approach may not fully reflect these local differences. This report addresses the need to better understand the audience profile surrounding each Reading Cinemas Victoria location and identify how demographic insight can support more informed film programming decisions.

The report uses 2021 Census demographic data to analyse the cinema suburb and wider surrounding catchment suburbs for each Reading Cinemas location. The analysis focuses on indicators that are relevant to cinema programming, including population size, age profile, family and household structure, country of birth, ancestry and language spoken at home. These indicators are used to identify potential opportunities for mainstream releases, language films, family programming, youth-focused films, premium sessions, community screenings and event cinema.

The findings show that locations such as Dandenong, Epping and Millers Junction have stronger multicultural and language-based programming opportunities, while Burwood has a strong opportunity for Chinese-language cinema. Melton and Sunbury show growing opportunities for selected South Asian, Arabic, Filipino, Turkish and European community programming. Chirnside Park, Traralgon and Waurin Ponds are better suited to a more mainstream-led approach, with stronger opportunities in family films, Australian films, mature-audience titles, youth/event cinema and selected international screenings.

Overall, this report recommends that Reading Cinemas use a location-aware programming strategy across Victoria. Mainstream releases should remain central across all cinemas, but selected language films, community screenings, family programming, premium sessions and event cinema should be tested where the local audience profile suggests stronger opportunity. Demographic data should be used as a planning tool, not as a fixed prediction of audience behaviour, with final programming decisions validated through ticket sales, occupancy, local marketing performance and customer response.

## **1. Purpose of the Report**

The purpose of this report is to understand the local audience profile surrounding Reading Cinemas' nine Victorian locations and identify how demographic insights can support more informed film programming decisions.

Reading Cinemas operates across different parts of Victoria, and each cinema location serves a different local community. The audience around Dandenong is not the same as the audience around Waurin Ponds, Sunbury, Traralgon or Burwood. Each location may have different population patterns, age groups, household types, cultural backgrounds, countries of birth and languages spoken at home. These differences can influence the types of films, languages, session times and cinema experiences that may be more relevant to each local audience.

This report uses demographic data to identify audience patterns across each cinema catchment area. The focus is on understanding who lives around each Reading Cinemas location, including key language groups, ancestry patterns, country-of-birth trends, family profiles and age groups. These insights can help Reading Cinemas consider where there may be stronger opportunities for language films, family programming, youth-focused releases, premium experiences, community screenings and event cinema.

The report is not intended to stereotype audiences or assume that demographic background alone determines movie preferences. Instead, it uses demographic data as a practical planning tool. The aim is to help Reading Cinemas make more informed decisions about programming, local marketing, session planning and future audience engagement across its Victorian cinema network.

## **2. Methodology**

This report uses 2021 Census demographic data to analyse the local audience profile surrounding Reading Cinemas' nine Victorian locations. The analysis focuses on the cinema suburb and a wider group of surrounding suburbs that are likely to form each cinema's realistic customer catchment.

The catchment approach was used because cinema customers do not only come from the exact suburb where the cinema is located. Customers may travel from neighbouring suburbs for major releases, language films, family outings, Gold Lounge sessions, group bookings, event cinema and convenient session times. For this reason, each cinema location has been analysed using a wider catchment area rather than the cinema suburb alone.

The demographic analysis focuses on indicators that are most relevant to film programming and local audience understanding. These include population size, age profile, household and family structure, country of birth, ancestry and language spoken at home. These indicators help identify where there may be stronger opportunities for language films, family programming, youth-focused releases, community screenings and premium cinema experiences.

### Methodology Overview

| Methodology Step                           | Description                                                                                                                                                                      | Purpose                                                      |
|--------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|
| Identify Reading Cinemas locations         | The report focuses on the nine Reading Cinemas locations in Victoria: Burwood, Chirnside Park, Dandenong, Epping, Melton, Millers Junction, Sunbury, Traralgon and Waurin Ponds. | Defines the scope of the report.                             |
| Define wider catchment suburbs             | Each cinema was assigned a core suburb and surrounding suburbs that are likely to contribute to the local cinema audience.                                                       | Creates a realistic view of each cinema's customer base.     |
| Use Census suburb-level data               | The analysis uses 2021 Census General Community Profile data for Victorian suburbs and localities.                                                                               | Provides an evidence base for demographic analysis.          |
| Analyse demographic indicators             | Key indicators include age groups, household type, ancestry, country of birth and language spoken at home.                                                                       | Identifies audience patterns relevant to film programming.   |
| Link insights to programming opportunities | Demographic patterns are translated into possible programming opportunities, such as language films, family films, youth films and event cinema.                                 | Connects demographic research to practical cinema decisions. |
| Apply caution in interpretation            | Demographic data is used as a guide, not as a fixed prediction of audience behaviour.                                                                                            | Avoids stereotyping and keeps recommendations professional.  |

The findings in this report should be treated as planning insights rather than absolute audience predictions. Demographic data can highlight potential opportunities, but programming decisions should also consider distributor availability, film popularity, release timing, ticket sales, local marketing activity and actual audience response.

Where a suburb name does not exactly match the Census suburb/locality data, the closest relevant Census geography should be used and noted during analysis. This ensures that the report remains transparent and consistent.

**Data source:** 2021 Census General Community Profile data for Victorian suburbs and localities. Catchment analysis is based on selected cinema suburbs and surrounding suburbs used as planning zones, not fixed customer boundaries.

### 3. Reading Cinemas Victoria Locations Covered

This report focuses on Reading Cinemas' Victorian cinema network and analyses the local audience profile surrounding each cinema location. The report does not only consider the suburb where each cinema is located. Instead, it uses a wider catchment approach to include nearby suburbs that may realistically contribute to each cinema's audience.

This approach is important because cinema customers often travel across surrounding suburbs for major film releases, language films, family outings, group bookings, premium experiences and convenient session times. Analysing only the cinema suburb would provide a limited view of the potential audience. A wider catchment gives Reading Cinemas a more practical understanding of the communities each cinema may serve.

#### Locations and Catchment Areas Covered

| Reading Cinemas Location       | Core Suburb    | Wider Catchment Suburbs                                                                                                           |
|--------------------------------|----------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Reading Cinemas Burwood        | Burwood        | Burwood East, Box Hill South, Ashwood, Ashburton, Glen Iris, Camberwell, Surrey Hills, Mount Waverley, Chadstone, Blackburn South |
| Reading Cinemas Chirnside Park | Chirnside Park | Lilydale, Mooroolbark, Croydon, Croydon North, Wonga Park, Kilsyth, Mount Evelyn, Ringwood, Warrandyte, Yarra Glen                |
| Reading Cinemas Dandenong      | Dandenong      | Dandenong North, Dandenong South, Noble                                                                                           |

|                                  |              |                                                                                                                                   |
|----------------------------------|--------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                                  |              | Park, Springvale, Keysborough, Endeavour Hills, Hallam, Hampton Park, Rowville, Mulgrave                                          |
| Reading Cinemas Epping           | Epping       | Lalor, Thomastown, Wollert, Mill Park, South Morang, Mernda, Bundoora, Reservoir, Craigieburn, Campbellfield                      |
| Reading Cinemas Melton           | Melton       | Melton South, Melton West, Kurunjang, Harkness, Brookfield, Caroline Springs, Rockbank, Bacchus Marsh, Toolern Vale, Taylors Hill |
| Reading Cinemas Millers Junction | Altona North | Altona, Newport, Spotswood, Williamstown, Brooklyn, Yarraville, Seddon, Footscray, Laverton, Point Cook                           |
| Reading Cinemas Sunbury          | Sunbury      | Diggers Rest, Bulla, Wildwood, Clarkefield, Gisborne, Macedon, Riddells Creek, Romsey, Craigieburn                                |
| Reading Cinemas Traralgon        | Traralgon    | Morwell, Churchill, Rosedale, Glengarry, Tyers, Moe, Yallourn North, Sale, Yinnar, Heyfield                                       |
| Reading Cinemas Waurin Ponds     | Waurin Ponds | Grovedale, Belmont, Highton, Mount Duneed, Armstrong Creek, Geelong, Newtown, Torquay, Marshall, Ocean Grove                      |

The catchment suburbs listed above provide the basis for the demographic analysis in the following sections. These suburbs will be used to identify local population patterns, key language groups, cultural backgrounds, age profiles, household structures and potential film programming opportunities for each Reading Cinemas location.

## 4. How Demographics Support Film Programming Decisions

Demographic data can help Reading Cinemas better understand the communities surrounding each cinema location. While demographics should not be used to make assumptions about individual audience preferences, they can provide useful signals about local audience needs, cultural interests, language demand and potential programming opportunities.

Each Reading Cinemas location operates within a different local catchment. Some locations may have stronger family populations, some may have younger student or youth audiences, and others may serve communities with higher concentrations of people who speak languages other than English at home. Understanding these patterns can help Reading Cinemas make more informed decisions about film selection, session planning, language releases, local marketing and community engagement.

### Demographic Indicators and Programming Relevance

| Demographic Indicator          | What It Helps Identify                                                                 | Programming Relevance                                                                                                            |
|--------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Language Spoken at Home        | Key non-English languages used within the local catchment.                             | Helps identify opportunities for language films, subtitled releases and community-targeted screenings.                           |
| Country of Birth               | Major overseas-born communities within the area.                                       | Supports understanding of cultural audience groups and potential interest in international film releases.                        |
| Ancestry                       | Broader cultural and community background.                                             | Helps identify where community-based programming, cultural festivals or selected international films may be relevant.            |
| Age Profile                    | The share of children, young adults, families, working-age adults and older residents. | Supports decisions around family films, youth-focused releases, horror, anime, premium sessions and mature audience programming. |
| Household and Family Structure | Family households, couples, group households and lone-person households.               | Helps guide family programming, date-night sessions, group outings and community event screenings.                               |

|                                  |                                                                                  |                                                                                                                            |
|----------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Student and Young Adult Presence | Areas with stronger youth, student or early-career populations.                  | May support anime, horror, action, superhero films, Korean/Japanese event cinema and social movie experiences.             |
| Income and Employment Profile    | General spending capacity and local lifestyle patterns.                          | Can support decisions around Gold Lounge, premium formats, food and beverage promotions and event cinema pricing.          |
| Regional or Urban Context        | Whether the cinema serves a metropolitan, growth corridor or regional catchment. | Helps adjust programming between mainstream releases, community films, family sessions and broader local-interest content. |

Demographic insights can support programming decisions in several practical ways. If a catchment has strong language diversity, Reading Cinemas may consider testing selected non-English language films or adding more targeted local marketing around relevant releases. If a catchment has a strong family population, family-friendly films, weekend sessions and school holiday programming may become more important. If a catchment has a younger audience profile, there may be stronger opportunities for anime, horror, action, superhero releases and event-style screenings.

The purpose of using demographics is not to replace programming judgement or box audiences into fixed categories. Film popularity, distributor availability, release timing, marketing support, ticket sales history and local cinema performance should still guide final programming decisions. Demographics should be used as an additional planning tool to help Reading Cinemas understand where certain film types, languages or cinema experiences may have stronger local relevance.

Overall, demographic data can help Reading Cinemas move from a general programming approach to a more location-aware programming strategy. By understanding the communities around each cinema, Reading Cinemas can better align selected films, session times, marketing messages and cinema experiences with the audience opportunities in each local catchment.

## 5. Location-by-Location Demographic Profiles

This section provides a demographic profile for each of Reading Cinemas' nine Victorian locations. Each profile considers the cinema suburb and its wider surrounding



catchment suburbs to understand the type of audience each location may realistically serve.

The analysis focuses on demographic indicators that are most useful for film programming decisions, including population size, age profile, household structure, country of birth, ancestry and language spoken at home. These indicators help identify where there may be opportunities for language films, family programming, youth-focused releases, premium sessions, community screenings and event cinema.

Each cinema profile follows the same structure to allow comparison across the Victorian network. The aim is not to make assumptions about individual audience preferences, but to identify local audience patterns that can support more informed programming and marketing decisions.

### 5.1 Reading Cinemas Burwood

**Catchment suburbs:** Burwood, Burwood East, Box Hill South, Ashwood, Ashburton, Glen Iris, Camberwell, Surrey Hills, Mount Waverley, Chadstone and Blackburn South.

Reading Cinemas Burwood sits within an established inner-eastern Melbourne catchment with a large and diverse local population. The wider catchment includes family households, older residents, young adults and several culturally diverse communities. The demographic profile suggests that Burwood has opportunities across mainstream releases, family programming, Chinese-language films, selected South Asian films, community-based international screenings and premium cinema experiences.

| Category                      | Local Demographic Insight                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | Programming Implication                                                                                                                                      |
|-------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Population and Catchment Size | The wider Burwood catchment has an estimated population of approximately <b>167,000 people</b> across the selected suburbs. Around <b>58.4%</b> of residents were born in Australia, while approximately <b>38.5%</b> were born overseas. | This is a large and diverse cinema catchment with enough scale to support both mainstream programming and selected international or language-based releases. |
| Age Profile                   | The catchment includes a broad age mix: approximately <b>16.4%</b> are aged 0–14, <b>13.9%</b> are aged 15–24, <b>39.8%</b> are aged 25–54 and <b>29.9%</b> are aged 55 and over.                                                         | Burwood should support a balanced program including family films, youth-focused releases, mainstream adult films, premium sessions and                       |

|                               |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
|-------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                               |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | selected mature-audience programming.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
| Language Spoken at Home       | Around <b>36.4%</b> of residents speak a language other than English at home. The largest non-English languages include <b>Mandarin, Greek, Cantonese, Sinhalese, Hindi, Vietnamese, Italian, Korean and Tamil</b> . Mandarin is particularly strong, with approximately <b>20,490 residents</b> speaking Mandarin at home. | The strongest language programming opportunity is Chinese-language cinema, especially Mandarin-language releases. There may also be smaller opportunities for Greek, Cantonese, South Asian, Vietnamese, Korean and Italian community-targeted screenings.                                |
| Country of Birth and Ancestry | Major overseas-born groups include people born in <b>China, India, Malaysia, England, Sri Lanka, Greece, Vietnam, Hong Kong, Italy, South Korea and Indonesia</b> . Key ancestry groups include <b>English, Australian, Chinese, Irish, Scottish, Greek, Indian and Italian</b> .                                           | The catchment has a strong multicultural profile, with a particularly strong Chinese community presence. This supports testing Chinese-language films, selected Indian/South Asian releases and occasional community-based screenings for Greek, Italian, Korean or Vietnamese audiences. |
| Household and Family Profile  | Around <b>71.9%</b> of occupied households in the catchment are family households. Couples without children and couples with children are both significant. One-person and two-person households are also common.                                                                                                           | Burwood can support family films, weekend sessions, school holiday programming, date-night films, premium sessions and adult-focused mainstream releases.                                                                                                                                 |
| Local Audience Character      | The area combines established family suburbs, older residents, multicultural communities and nearby young adult/student audiences.                                                                                                                                                                                          | Programming should not focus on only one segment. A mixed schedule is more suitable, combining mainstream releases with selected language films and premium experiences.                                                                                                                  |

### Recommended programming focus:

Reading Cinemas Burwood should maintain a strong mainstream film schedule while using the local demographic profile to test selected language and community-based programming. The strongest opportunity is **Mandarin and broader Chinese-language cinema**, supported by the high number of Mandarin speakers and strong Chinese ancestry presence in the catchment.

Burwood may also benefit from selected **Cantonese-language films, South Asian films** such as Hindi, Tamil or Sinhalese-related releases, and occasional **Greek, Italian, Korean or Vietnamese community screenings** where distributor availability and local demand support them.

From an audience-type perspective, Burwood should also continue to support **family films, school holiday programming, premium date-night sessions, mature-audience films and event cinema**. The catchment is broad enough to justify a balanced programming strategy rather than a single-language or single-segment focus.

### 5.2 Reading Cinemas Chirnside Park

**Catchment suburbs:** Chirnside Park, Lilydale, Mooroolbark, Croydon, Croydon North, Wonga Park, Kilsyth, Mount Evelyn, Ringwood, Warrandyte and Yarra Glen.

Reading Cinemas Chirnside Park serves an outer-eastern Melbourne catchment with a strong family and established suburban profile. Compared with more culturally dense metropolitan locations such as Burwood, Dandenong or Epping, this catchment has a higher Australian-born population and a stronger English-speaking audience base. However, there are still multicultural audience segments that may support selected international and language-based programming when matched with the right release and local marketing.

| Category                      | Local Demographic Insight                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Programming Implication                                                                                                                                                   |
|-------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Population and Catchment Size | The wider Chirnside Park catchment has an estimated population of approximately <b>141,900 people</b> across the selected suburbs. Around <b>74.5%</b> of residents were born in Australia, while approximately <b>22.5%</b> were born overseas. | This is a sizeable outer-eastern catchment with a strong mainstream audience base. Programming should be led by major releases, family films and broad commercial titles. |
| Age Profile                   | The catchment includes approximately <b>18.4%</b> aged 0–14, <b>11.6%</b> aged 15–24,                                                                                                                                                            | Chirnside Park should support family films, school holiday releases,                                                                                                      |

|                               |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
|-------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                               | <b>40.6%</b> aged 25–54 and <b>29.5%</b> aged 55 and over.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | mainstream adult films and selected mature-audience programming. The older resident share also supports daytime and early evening sessions.                                                                                                                                                        |
| Language Spoken at Home       | Around <b>15.5%</b> of residents speak a language other than English at home. The largest non-English languages include <b>Mandarin, Cantonese, Italian, Persian, Hindi, Punjabi, Greek, Spanish, Sinhalese, Arabic, Vietnamese</b> and <b>Korean</b> . Mandarin is the largest non-English language group, with approximately <b>4,185 residents</b> speaking Mandarin at home. | Language-film opportunities exist, but they should be selective rather than central to the program. The strongest opportunities are occasional Mandarin or broader Chinese-language films, with smaller opportunities for Indian, Persian, Italian, Greek or Korean community-targeted screenings. |
| Country of Birth and Ancestry | Major overseas-born groups include people born in <b>England, China, Myanmar, India, New Zealand, Malaysia, South Africa, Netherlands, Italy, Iran, Philippines, Germany, Sri Lanka</b> and <b>Hong Kong</b> . Key ancestry groups include <b>English, Australian, Irish, Scottish, Italian, Chinese, German, Dutch, Indian</b> and <b>Greek</b> .                               | The catchment has a strong Anglo-Australian base with smaller multicultural audience segments. This supports mainstream programming first, with selected international films tested as limited sessions or event-style releases.                                                                   |
| Household and Family Profile  | Around <b>73.6%</b> of occupied households in the catchment are family households. Couple families and one-parent families are both significant, with a strong presence of households with children.                                                                                                                                                                             | Chirnside Park should continue to prioritise family films, weekend sessions, school holiday programming and accessible session times for parents and children.                                                                                                                                     |
| Local Audience Character      | The area is mainly an established suburban and family-oriented                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | Programming should focus on mainstream commercial releases,                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |

|  |                                                                                        |                                                                                                                                    |
|--|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|  | catchment, with a mix of older residents, families and some multicultural communities. | family films, mature-audience titles, selected premium experiences and occasional international films where local demand is clear. |
|--|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

### Recommended programming focus:

Reading Cinemas Chirnside Park should maintain a strong mainstream and family-focused programming strategy. The local demographic profile suggests that major Hollywood releases, family films, animated films, school holiday titles, Australian releases and mature-audience films are likely to remain important for this location.

Language and cultural programming should be treated as a selective opportunity rather than the main programming direction. The strongest non-English opportunity is **Mandarin and broader Chinese-language cinema**, supported by Mandarin and Cantonese speakers in the catchment. There may also be occasional opportunities for **Indian-language films, Persian/Iranian community films, Italian or Greek community screenings, and Korean or Japanese event cinema**, depending on release availability and local audience response.

Overall, Chirnside Park should be positioned as a **mainstream family and suburban cinema location** with selective cultural programming opportunities. The best approach would be to test language or community films through limited sessions, special screenings or targeted local marketing rather than relying on them as a core schedule driver.

### 5.3 Reading Cinemas Dandenong

**Catchment suburbs:** Dandenong, Dandenong North, Dandenong South, Noble Park, Springvale, Keysborough, Endeavour Hills, Hallam, Hampton Park, Rowville and Mulgrave.

Reading Cinemas Dandenong sits within one of the strongest multicultural cinema catchments in Victoria. The wider catchment has a large population, a high overseas-born share and a very high proportion of residents who speak a language other than English at home. This creates strong opportunities for language-based film programming, community screenings and targeted local marketing alongside mainstream commercial releases.

| Category                      | Local Demographic Insight            | Programming Implication                             |
|-------------------------------|--------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|
| Population and Catchment Size | The wider Dandenong catchment has an | This is a large and highly multicultural catchment. |

|                               |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
|-------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                               | estimated population of approximately <b>252,600 people</b> across the selected suburbs. Around <b>42.5%</b> of residents were born in Australia, while approximately <b>52.7%</b> were born overseas.                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Dandenong has strong potential to support both mainstream releases and selected international or language-based films.                                                                                                                                                                        |
| Age Profile                   | The catchment includes approximately <b>17.9%</b> aged 0–14, <b>12.7%</b> aged 15–24, <b>42.5%</b> aged 25–54 and <b>26.9%</b> aged 55 and over.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | The age profile supports family films, youth-focused releases, mainstream adult titles, community screenings and evening/weekend programming for working-age audiences.                                                                                                                       |
| Language Spoken at Home       | Around <b>56.2%</b> of residents speak a language other than English at home. The largest non-English languages include <b>Vietnamese, Mandarin, Khmer, Sinhalese, Punjabi, Cantonese, Greek, Arabic, Tamil, Hindi, Serbian, Italian, Urdu, Spanish, Turkish, Tagalog, Persian, Malayalam, Filipino</b> and <b>Korean</b> .                                                                                             | Dandenong has one of the strongest language-programming opportunities. Vietnamese, Chinese-language, South Asian, Sri Lankan, Cambodian/Khmer, Arabic, Turkish, Persian, Serbian, Greek and Italian community screenings may all have relevance depending on release availability and demand. |
| Country of Birth and Ancestry | Major overseas-born groups include people born in <b>India, Vietnam, Sri Lanka, Afghanistan, China, Cambodia, Malaysia, Philippines, New Zealand, Pakistan, England, Greece, Italy, Mauritius, Bosnia and Herzegovina, Iran</b> and <b>Thailand</b> . Major ancestry groups include <b>English, Australian, Chinese, Vietnamese, Indian, Italian, Irish, Greek, Scottish, Sri Lankan, Filipino</b> and <b>Serbian</b> . | The catchment has strong South Asian, Vietnamese, Chinese, Sri Lankan, Cambodian, Afghan, Middle Eastern and European community patterns. Programming should be more culturally diverse than at many other Victorian Reading Cinemas locations.                                               |

|                              |                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
|------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Household and Family Profile | Around <b>76.3%</b> of occupied households in the catchment are family households. The catchment includes a strong mix of couples with children, couples without children, one-parent families and larger households. | Dandenong can support family programming, weekend sessions, school holiday releases, group outings and community-based screenings. Larger family and multicultural household patterns may also support group attendance for major language films. |
| Local Audience Character     | The area has a highly diverse audience base with strong multicultural, family and working-age population segments.                                                                                                    | Programming should combine mainstream blockbusters with a stronger language-film and community-screening strategy than more traditional suburban locations.                                                                                       |

#### **Recommended programming focus:**

Reading Cinemas Dandenong should be treated as a **high-priority location for multicultural and language-based programming**. The strongest opportunities appear to be **Vietnamese films, Chinese-language films, and South Asian language films**, including **Hindi, Punjabi, Tamil, Malayalam and Urdu-related releases** where distributor availability supports them.

There may also be opportunities to test **Sri Lankan community screenings, Cambodian/Khmer community films, Arabic-language films, Turkish or Persian/Iranian community content**, and selected **Greek, Italian, Serbian or Filipino community screenings**. These should be planned carefully around release strength, local marketing and session demand.

From an audience-type perspective, Dandenong should also continue to support **mainstream blockbusters, family films, school holiday programming, action films, horror, youth-focused releases and group-friendly sessions**. The best approach is a mixed programming strategy where mainstream titles remain strong, but selected language and community films are given more deliberate visibility and targeted session planning.

#### **5.4 Reading Cinemas Epping**

**Catchment suburbs:** Epping, Lalor, Thomastown, Wollert, Mill Park, South Morang, Mernda, Bundoora, Reservoir, Craigieburn and Campbellfield.

Reading Cinemas Epping sits within a large northern Melbourne growth-corridor catchment. The wider catchment includes established migrant communities, newer growth suburbs, family households and a strong working-age population. The demographic profile shows a highly diverse audience base, with strong opportunities for mainstream releases, family programming, South Asian films, Arabic-language or Middle Eastern community films, Italian/Greek/Macedonian community screenings, and selected Chinese, Vietnamese and Turkish releases.

| Category                      | Local Demographic Insight                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | Programming Implication                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|-------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Population and Catchment Size | The wider Epping catchment has an estimated population of approximately <b>327,700 people</b> across the selected suburbs. Around <b>53.9%</b> of residents were born in Australia, while approximately <b>41.6%</b> were born overseas.                                                                                  | This is a very large catchment with strong population scale. Epping can support mainstream blockbusters while also testing selected language and community-based films.                                                                                                 |
| Age Profile                   | The catchment includes approximately <b>20.5%</b> aged 0–14, <b>12.2%</b> aged 15–24, <b>44.6%</b> aged 25–54 and <b>22.7%</b> aged 55 and over.                                                                                                                                                                          | The strong child, family and working-age profile supports family films, school holiday programming, evening sessions, weekend sessions, action films, horror, comedy and group-friendly releases.                                                                       |
| Language Spoken at Home       | Around <b>50.3%</b> of residents speak a language other than English at home. Major non-English languages include <b>Arabic, Punjabi, Italian, Macedonian, Greek, Mandarin, Hindi, Vietnamese, Turkish, Sinhalese, Urdu, Nepali, Malayalam, Tamil, Cantonese, Persian, Tagalog, Spanish, Filipino</b> and <b>Samoan</b> . | Epping has strong language-programming potential. The most relevant opportunities are Arabic/Middle Eastern community films, South Asian films, Italian/Greek/Macedonian community screenings, Chinese-language films, Vietnamese films and Turkish community releases. |
| Country of Birth and Ancestry | Major overseas-born groups include people born in <b>India, Iraq, Italy,</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | The catchment has a strong mix of South Asian, Middle Eastern, European,                                                                                                                                                                                                |



|                              |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
|------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                              | <b>China, North Macedonia, Sri Lanka, Greece, Vietnam, Philippines, New Zealand, Lebanon, Nepal, England, Pakistan, Iran and Turkey.</b> Key ancestry groups include <b>Australian, English, Italian, Indian, Greek, Macedonian, Chinese, Irish, Scottish, Lebanese, Vietnamese, Filipino, Maltese, German, Sri Lankan and Samoan.</b> | Chinese, Vietnamese and Filipino community patterns. Programming should be more culturally diverse than a standard suburban schedule.                                                                                                           |
| Household and Family Profile | Around <b>76.5%</b> of occupied households in the catchment are family households. The area includes many couples with children, larger households and working-age families.                                                                                                                                                           | Epping should strongly support family films, weekend sessions, school holiday releases, group attendance and community screenings. Larger family and multicultural household patterns may also support strong turnout for major language films. |
| Local Audience Character     | The catchment combines growth suburbs, established multicultural communities, young families and working-age residents.                                                                                                                                                                                                                | Programming should combine mainstream commercial films with deliberate language-film testing and local community marketing.                                                                                                                     |

### Recommended programming focus:

Reading Cinemas Epping should be treated as a **high-potential multicultural and family-focused cinema location**. The strongest programming opportunities appear to be **South Asian films**, especially **Punjabi, Hindi, Tamil, Malayalam, Urdu and Nepali-related releases**, supported by strong language and country-of-birth indicators across the catchment.

There is also a strong opportunity to test **Arabic-language and Middle Eastern community films**, particularly due to Arabic speakers and communities connected to Iraq, Lebanon and Iran. Epping may also support **Italian, Greek and Macedonian community screenings**, especially for selected cultural releases or event-style screenings.

Additional opportunities include **Chinese-language films, Vietnamese films, Turkish community films, Filipino community screenings**, and selected **Korean/Japanese event cinema** where distributor availability and local demand support them.

From an audience-type perspective, Epping should also prioritise **family films, school holiday programming, mainstream blockbusters, action films, horror, comedy, youth-focused releases and group-friendly weekend sessions**. The best approach is a mixed programming strategy where mainstream films remain central, but selected language and community films are programmed more deliberately with targeted local promotion.

### 5.5 Reading Cinemas Melton

**Catchment suburbs:** Melton, Melton South, Melton West, Kurunjang, Harkness, Brookfield, Caroline Springs, Rockbank, Bacchus Marsh, Toolern Vale and Taylors Hill.

Reading Cinemas Melton serves a western growth-corridor catchment with a strong family profile, a growing multicultural population and a large working-age audience. The wider catchment includes established Melton suburbs, newer growth areas and neighbouring western suburbs that may contribute to cinema attendance for major releases, family films, language films and weekend sessions.

| Category                      | Local Demographic Insight                                                                                                                                                                                                                | Programming Implication                                                                                                                                                                                |
|-------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Population and Catchment Size | The wider Melton catchment has an estimated population of approximately <b>113,200 people</b> across the selected suburbs. Around <b>62.6%</b> of residents were born in Australia, while approximately <b>31.8%</b> were born overseas. | Melton has a strong local audience base with both mainstream and multicultural programming potential. Major releases should remain central, with selected language films tested based on local demand. |
| Age Profile                   | The catchment has a young and family-oriented profile. Approximately <b>23.5%</b> of residents are aged 0–14, <b>12.9%</b> are aged 15–24, <b>42.7%</b> are aged 25–54 and <b>20.9%</b> are aged 55 and over.                            | The strong child, family and working-age population supports family films, animated releases, school holiday programming, action films, horror, comedy and weekend/evening sessions.                   |
| Language Spoken at Home       | Around <b>33.1%</b> of residents speak a language other than English at home. Major non-English                                                                                                                                          | The strongest language-programming opportunities are South Asian films, especially                                                                                                                     |

|                               |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |
|-------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                               | languages include <b>Punjabi, Vietnamese, Arabic, Hindi, Macedonian, Tagalog/Filipino, Urdu, Spanish, Samoan, Mandarin, Italian, Greek, Croatian, Serbian, Turkish, Sinhalese, Bengali and Tamil.</b>                                                                                                                                                                                       | Punjabi and Hindi releases, along with Vietnamese, Arabic/Middle Eastern, Filipino, Macedonian/Balkan and selected Tamil or Urdu-related releases.                                                                                                             |
| Country of Birth and Ancestry | Major overseas-born groups include people born in <b>India, Philippines, New Zealand, England, Vietnam, Malta, Pakistan, Sri Lanka, North Macedonia, China, Iraq, Samoa, Myanmar, Egypt and Italy.</b> Major ancestry groups include <b>Australian, English, Maltese, Indian, Irish, Italian, Scottish, Filipino, Chinese, Vietnamese, Macedonian, Greek, Croatian, Samoan and Serbian.</b> | The catchment has a mixed mainstream and multicultural audience profile. Programming should consider Indian/South Asian films, Filipino community screenings, Vietnamese films, Pacific community interest, and selected European/Balkan community screenings. |
| Household and Family Profile  | Around <b>77.7%</b> of occupied households in the catchment are family households. The area has a strong presence of couples with children, larger family households and working-age families.                                                                                                                                                                                              | Melton should strongly support family films, school holiday releases, weekend sessions, group-friendly programming and community-based screenings.                                                                                                             |
| Local Audience Character      | The area combines young families, western growth-corridor residents, multicultural communities and a strong working-age population.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | Programming should focus on mainstream commercial releases while testing selected language films and community screenings that match local demographic patterns.                                                                                               |

### **Recommended programming focus:**

Reading Cinemas Melton should be positioned as a **family-focused western growth-**

**corridor cinema** with selected multicultural programming opportunities. The strongest programming opportunity is likely to be **South Asian cinema**, especially **Punjabi and Hindi films**, with additional opportunities for **Tamil, Urdu, Bengali and Sinhalese-related releases** where distributor availability and demand support them.

Melton may also support selected **Vietnamese films, Arabic-language or Middle Eastern community films, Filipino/Tagalog community screenings**, and **Macedonian, Greek, Italian, Croatian or Serbian community films** for suitable releases or special events.

From an audience-type perspective, Melton should prioritise **family films, animated releases, school holiday programming, mainstream blockbusters, action films, horror, comedy and weekend group sessions**. Because the catchment has a young family base and a growing multicultural profile, the best approach is to maintain strong mainstream programming while testing language films through selected sessions and targeted local promotion.

## 5.6 Reading Cinemas Millers Junction

**Catchment suburbs:** Altona North, Altona, Newport, Spotswood, Williamstown, Brooklyn, Yarraville, Seddon, Footscray, Laverton and Point Cook.

Reading Cinemas Millers Junction sits within a large western and inner-west Melbourne catchment. The wider catchment combines established suburbs such as Williamstown, Newport, Yarraville and Seddon with growth and multicultural areas such as Point Cook, Footscray, Laverton and Altona North. This creates a mixed audience profile with strong opportunities for mainstream releases, family films, South Asian films, Chinese-language films, Vietnamese films, selected Middle Eastern and European community screenings, and premium cinema experiences.

| Category                      | Local Demographic Insight                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | Programming Implication                                                                                                                               |
|-------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Population and Catchment Size | The wider Millers Junction catchment has an estimated population of approximately <b>166,800 people</b> across the selected suburbs. Around <b>56.5%</b> of residents were born in Australia, while approximately <b>39.1%</b> were born overseas. | This is a large and diverse catchment with enough scale to support mainstream programming as well as selected international and language-based films. |
| Age Profile                   | The catchment includes approximately <b>21.5%</b> aged 0–14, <b>10.3%</b> aged 15–24,                                                                                                                                                              | The strong child, family and working-age profile supports family films, school holiday releases,                                                      |

|                               |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|-------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                               | <b>48.5%</b> aged 25–54 and <b>19.8%</b> aged 55 and over.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | action films, comedy, horror, date-night films, premium sessions and evening/weekend programming.                                                                                                                                                                            |
| Language Spoken at Home       | Around <b>36.5%</b> of residents speak a language other than English at home. Major non-English languages include <b>Mandarin, Hindi, Vietnamese, Arabic, Greek, Punjabi, Cantonese, Italian, Spanish, Urdu, Macedonian, Tamil, Gujarati, Indonesian, Tagalog, Bengali, Filipino, Croatian, Serbian, Korean, Nepali, Sinhalese</b> and <b>Malayalam</b> .                                                                                      | Millers Junction has meaningful language-programming potential. The strongest opportunities are South Asian films, Chinese-language films and Vietnamese films, with additional opportunities for Arabic, Greek, Italian, Filipino, Balkan and Korean/Japanese event cinema. |
| Country of Birth and Ancestry | Major overseas-born groups include people born in <b>India, China, England, New Zealand, Vietnam, Philippines, Malaysia, Italy, South Africa, Greece, Indonesia, Pakistan, North Macedonia, Lebanon, Sri Lanka</b> and <b>Singapore</b> . Key ancestry groups include <b>English, Australian, Irish, Chinese, Indian, Scottish, Italian, Greek, Vietnamese, German, Maltese, Filipino, Lebanese, Macedonian, Croatian</b> and <b>Serbian</b> . | The catchment has a broad multicultural profile with strong Indian, Chinese, Vietnamese, Filipino, Greek, Italian and Middle Eastern community indicators. Programming should be more diverse than a standard mainstream-only schedule.                                      |
| Household and Family Profile  | Around <b>73.2%</b> of occupied households in the catchment are family households. The catchment includes couples with children,                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Millers Junction should support family films, school holiday programming, group-friendly sessions, premium date-night sessions and                                                                                                                                           |

|                          |                                                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                                             |
|--------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                          | couples without children, young families, larger households and established adult households.                                         | selected community screenings.                                                                                                              |
| Local Audience Character | The area combines inner-west lifestyle suburbs, western growth suburbs, multicultural communities and family-heavy residential areas. | Programming should balance mainstream commercial releases with selected language films, premium experiences and community-based screenings. |

### Recommended programming focus:

Reading Cinemas Millers Junction should be positioned as a **diverse western and inner-west cinema location** with strong mainstream, family and multicultural programming opportunities. The strongest language-film opportunities appear to be **South Asian films**, especially **Hindi, Punjabi, Tamil, Urdu, Gujarati, Bengali, Malayalam and Nepali-related releases**, supported by the large Indian and South Asian community indicators across the catchment.

There is also a strong opportunity to test **Chinese-language films**, especially **Mandarin and Cantonese releases**, along with selected **Vietnamese films**. These should be supported through targeted local marketing and limited-session testing where distributor availability and release strength make sense.

Additional opportunities may include **Arabic-language or Middle Eastern community films, Greek and Italian community screenings, Filipino/Tagalog films, Macedonian, Croatian or Serbian community films**, and selected **Korean or Japanese event cinema**.

From an audience-type perspective, Millers Junction should prioritise **family films, school holiday releases, mainstream blockbusters, action films, horror, comedy, date-night titles and premium cinema experiences**. The best approach is a balanced programming strategy that reflects both the established inner-west audience and the multicultural growth-corridor audience around Point Cook and surrounding suburbs.

### 5.7 Reading Cinemas Sunbury

**Catchment suburbs:** Sunbury, Diggers Rest, Bulla, Wildwood, Clarkefield, Gisborne, Macedon, Riddells Creek, Romsey and Craigieburn.

Reading Cinemas Sunbury serves a mixed north-western and outer-regional catchment. The cinema's local audience includes established Sunbury residents, nearby Macedon Ranges communities and growth-corridor suburbs such as Diggers Rest and Craigieburn. This gives the catchment a strong family profile, a large Australian-born

population and a growing multicultural audience base, particularly when the wider catchment is considered.

| Category                      | Local Demographic Insight                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | Programming Implication                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
|-------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Population and Catchment Size | The wider Sunbury catchment has an estimated population of approximately <b>133,300 people</b> across the selected suburbs. Around <b>63.9%</b> of residents were born in Australia, while approximately <b>31.9%</b> were born overseas.                                                                                                   | Sunbury has a strong mainstream audience base with growing multicultural programming potential. Major releases should remain central, with selected language films tested carefully.                                                         |
| Age Profile                   | The catchment has a young and family-oriented profile. Approximately <b>22.8%</b> of residents are aged 0–14, <b>12.4%</b> are aged 15–24, <b>43.5%</b> are aged 25–54 and <b>21.4%</b> are aged 55 and over.                                                                                                                               | The strong child, family and working-age profile supports family films, school holiday programming, mainstream blockbusters, action films, horror, comedy and weekend/evening sessions                                                       |
| Language Spoken at Home       | Around <b>33.6%</b> of residents speak a language other than English at home. Major non-English languages include <b>Punjabi, Arabic, Turkish, Hindi, Sinhalese, Urdu, Italian, Nepali, Samoan, Malayalam, Greek, Tagalog, Mandarin, Filipino, Tamil, Spanish, Gujarati, Vietnamese, Macedonian, Croatian, Bengali</b> and <b>Persian</b> . | The strongest language-programming opportunities are South Asian films, especially Punjabi and Hindi releases, along with Arabic/Middle Eastern, Turkish, Sri Lankan/Sinhalese, Filipino, Samoan and selected European community screenings. |
| Country of Birth and Ancestry | Major overseas-born groups include people born in <b>India, Iraq, England, New Zealand, Sri Lanka, Philippines, Pakistan, Turkey, Nepal, Italy, Lebanon, Malta, Fiji, Samoa, China, Germany, Vietnam, South Africa, Malaysia</b> and <b>Iran</b> . Major                                                                                    | The catchment combines a strong Anglo-Australian base with South Asian, Middle Eastern, European, Filipino, Pacific Islander and Sri Lankan community indicators. Programming should remain mainstream-led but include targeted              |

|                              |                                                                                                                                                                                         |                                                                                                                                          |
|------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                              | ancestry groups include <b>Australian, English, Irish, Indian, Scottish, Italian, Maltese, German, Filipino, Greek, Chinese, Lebanese, Samoan, Sri Lankan, Croatian and Dutch.</b>      | multicultural releases where demand is clear.                                                                                            |
| Household and Family Profile | Around <b>80.5%</b> of occupied households in the catchment are family households. The area has a strong presence of couples with children, larger households and working-age families. | Sunbury should strongly support family films, animated releases, school holiday titles, weekend sessions and group-friendly programming. |
| Local Audience Character     | The area combines family-heavy suburbs, outer-growth communities, regional-edge towns and multicultural growth-corridor audiences.                                                      | Programming should balance mainstream commercial films with family-focused programming and selective language-film testing.              |

#### **Recommended programming focus:**

Reading Cinemas Sunbury should be positioned as a **family-focused north-western cinema location** with selected multicultural programming opportunities. The strongest audience opportunity remains **mainstream commercial films**, including major Hollywood releases, Australian films, family films, animated films, action, comedy, horror and school holiday programming.

The strongest language-film opportunity appears to be **South Asian cinema**, especially **Punjabi and Hindi films**, with additional opportunities for **Urdu, Nepali, Malayalam, Tamil, Gujarati, Bengali and Sinhalese-related releases** where distributor availability and local demand support them.

Sunbury may also support selected **Arabic-language and Middle Eastern community films, Turkish films, Filipino/Tagalog community screenings, Samoan or Pacific community interest films**, and occasional **Italian, Greek, Maltese, Macedonian, Croatian or other European community screenings** for suitable releases.

The best approach for Sunbury is not to over-program language films, but to test them through **limited sessions, weekend screenings and targeted local promotion**. The location should remain mainstream and family-led, while using demographic insight to identify selected cultural programming opportunities.



## 5.8 Reading Cinemas Traralgon

**Catchment suburbs:** Traralgon, Morwell, Churchill, Rosedale, Glengarry, Tyers, Moe, Yallourn North, Sale, Yinnar and Heyfield.

Reading Cinemas Traralgon serves a regional Latrobe Valley and Gippsland catchment. Compared with the metropolitan Melbourne locations, this catchment has a stronger Australian-born and English-speaking population profile, a larger older resident share and a more regional family-oriented audience base. The demographic profile suggests that Traralgon's strongest opportunities are mainstream releases, family films, Australian/local-interest content, mature-audience films, school holiday programming and selected community or event cinema rather than heavy language-film programming.

| Category                      | Local Demographic Insight                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Programming Implication                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
|-------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Population and Catchment Size | The wider Traralgon catchment has an estimated population of approximately <b>78,200 people</b> across the selected suburbs. Around <b>79.0%</b> of residents were born in Australia, while approximately <b>13.0%</b> were born overseas.              | Traralgon has a smaller and more regionally concentrated catchment than the metropolitan locations. Programming should be led by mainstream commercial films, family titles and broad community appeal.                     |
| Age Profile                   | The catchment includes approximately <b>17.8%</b> aged 0–14, <b>11.1%</b> aged 15–24, <b>36.3%</b> aged 25–54 and <b>34.9%</b> aged 55 and over.                                                                                                        | The higher older resident share supports mature-audience films, Australian films, drama, comedy, local-interest content and daytime or early evening sessions. Family and school holiday programming also remains important |
| Language Spoken at Home       | Around 7.0% of residents speak a language other than English at home. The largest non-English languages include Italian, Mandarin, Greek, Malayalam, Tagalog/Filipino, Punjabi, Vietnamese, Arabic, Sinhalese, Spanish, Hindi, German, Cantonese, Urdu, | Language-film opportunities exist, but they should be limited and carefully tested. Traralgon is better suited to mainstream programming, with occasional international or community screenings for selected releases.      |

|                               |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
|-------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                               | Polish, Thai, Croatian and Tamil.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| Country of Birth and Ancestry | Major overseas-born groups include people born in <b>England, New Zealand, India, Philippines, Netherlands, Italy, Scotland, Germany, China, Malta, South Africa, Sri Lanka, Malaysia, USA, Thailand</b> and <b>Vietnam</b> . Major ancestry groups include <b>Australian, English, Scottish, Irish, Italian, German, Dutch, Aboriginal Australian, Maltese, Filipino, Chinese, Indian, Polish</b> and <b>Greek</b> . | The catchment has a strong Anglo-Australian and regional profile, with smaller multicultural communities. Programming should prioritise broad mainstream appeal, while using selected cultural screenings only where there is clear demand. |
| Household and Family Profile  | Around <b>63.2%</b> of occupied households in the catchment are family households. The catchment also has a notable share of non-family and smaller households.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | Traralgon should support family films, school holiday programming, adult dramas, comedy, mature-audience films and accessible session times for different household types.                                                                  |
| Local Audience Character      | The area combines regional families, older residents, working-age adults and smaller multicultural communities across the Latrobe Valley and Gippsland region.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Programming should focus on mainstream commercial releases, family titles, Australian films, mature-audience content, community events and selected special screenings.                                                                     |

### **Recommended programming focus:**

Reading Cinemas Traralgon should be positioned as a **regional mainstream and family-focused cinema location**. The strongest programming opportunities are likely to be **major Hollywood releases, Australian films, family films, animated films, school holiday titles, comedy, drama, action, thriller and mature-audience films**.

Because the catchment has a higher older resident share than many metropolitan locations, Traralgon may also benefit from **daytime sessions, early evening sessions,**

**Australian/local-interest films, British or European dramas, comedy-dramas and community-style screenings.**

Language-film programming should be treated as a selective opportunity rather than a core strategy. There may be occasional opportunities for **Italian, Greek, Filipino/Tagalog, Indian/South Asian, Chinese-language or Vietnamese films**, but these should be tested through limited sessions, special events or targeted local promotion rather than regular programming.

Overall, Traralgon should remain **mainstream-led, family-friendly and regionally focused**, with selected event cinema and community screenings used to broaden engagement where local demand is clear.

### **5.9 Reading Cinemas Waurin Ponds**

**Catchment suburbs:** Waurin Ponds, Grovedale, Belmont, Highton, Mount Duneed, Armstrong Creek, Geelong, Newtown, Torquay, Marshall and Ocean Grove.

Reading Cinemas Waurin Ponds serves a wider Geelong and Surf Coast catchment. The area includes established Geelong suburbs, family-oriented growth areas, young adults, coastal communities and regional-city audiences. Compared with metropolitan multicultural locations such as Dandenong, Epping or Millers Junction, the Waurin Ponds catchment has a stronger Australian-born and English-speaking profile. However, the catchment still includes selected multicultural communities that may support targeted international and language-based programming when matched with the right release.

| <b>Category</b>               | <b>Local Demographic Insight</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                               | <b>Programming Implication</b>                                                                                                                                                               |
|-------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Population and Catchment Size | The wider Waurin Ponds catchment has an estimated population of approximately <b>127,900 people</b> across the selected suburbs. Around <b>79.8%</b> of residents were born in Australia, while approximately <b>16.4%</b> were born overseas. | Waurin Ponds has a strong regional-city audience base. Programming should be led by mainstream releases, family films, Australian films, youth-focused titles and broad commercial releases. |
| Age Profile                   | The catchment includes approximately <b>19.3%</b> aged 0–14, <b>12.4%</b> aged 15–24, <b>39.9%</b> aged 25–54 and <b>28.5%</b> aged 55 and over.                                                                                               | The age profile supports family films, school holiday programming, youth-focused releases, adult mainstream films, mature-audience titles                                                    |

|                               |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
|-------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                               |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | and daytime or early evening sessions.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| Language Spoken at Home       | Around <b>9.8%</b> of residents speak a language other than English at home. Major non-English languages include <b>Mandarin, Punjabi, Italian, Malayalam, Hindi, Spanish, Arabic, German, Sinhalese, Greek, Persian, Urdu, Cantonese, French, Vietnamese, Filipino/Tagalog, Croatian, Japanese, Tamil, Macedonian and Nepali.</b>                                                                                               | Language-film opportunities exist, but they should be selective rather than central to the schedule. The strongest opportunities are limited-session testing for Chinese-language films, South Asian films, Italian/Greek community screenings, and selected Japanese/Korean-style event cinema or anime releases. |
| Country of Birth and Ancestry | Major overseas-born groups include people born in England, India, New Zealand, China, South Africa, Philippines, Scotland, Italy, Germany, Netherlands, United States, Sri Lanka, Malaysia, Ireland, Iran, Canada, Pakistan and Vietnam. Key ancestry groups include English, Australian, Irish, Scottish, German, Italian, Dutch, Chinese, Indian, Polish, Aboriginal Australian, Greek, Croatian, Filipino, Welsh and Maltese. | The catchment has a strong Anglo-Australian and European ancestry base, with smaller South Asian, Chinese, Filipino and Sri Lankan communities. Programming should remain mainstream-led, with selected cultural films used as targeted opportunities.                                                             |
| Household and Family Profile  | Around 70.9% of occupied households in the catchment are family households. The catchment also includes couples without children, lone-person households and smaller adult households.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Waurin Ponds should support family films, school holiday releases, weekend sessions, date-night films, mature-audience titles and accessible session times for different household types.                                                                                                                          |
| Local Audience Character      | The area combines Geelong families, young                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Programming should balance mainstream                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |

|  |                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                                                                        |
|--|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|  | adults, regional-city residents, coastal communities and smaller multicultural audience groups. | commercial releases with family programming, youth-focused films, Australian/local-interest content, selected premium sessions and limited international film testing. |
|--|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

### **Recommended programming focus:**

Reading Cinemas Waurin Ponds should be positioned as a **mainstream regional-city and family-focused cinema location**. The strongest programming opportunities are likely to be **major Hollywood releases, Australian films, family films, animated films, school holiday titles, comedy, drama, action, horror, romance and mature-audience films**.

Because the catchment includes young adults and a regional-city audience, Waurin Ponds may also support **anime, Japanese event cinema, horror, superhero films, action films, music/event cinema and social movie experiences**. These releases may work particularly well when promoted as limited-time events or weekend sessions.

Language-film programming should be treated as a selective opportunity rather than a core strategy. The strongest opportunities appear to be **Mandarin and broader Chinese-language films, South Asian films** such as **Punjabi, Hindi, Malayalam, Tamil, Urdu and Sinhalese-related releases**, and occasional **Italian, Greek, Filipino/Tagalog, Vietnamese or Persian community screenings** where distributor availability and local demand support them.

Overall, Waurin Ponds should remain **mainstream-led, family-friendly and regional-city focused**, while using selected international, event and youth-focused programming to broaden audience engagement.

## **6. Comparative Location Summary**

The nine Reading Cinemas Victoria locations serve very different local audience catchments. Some locations, such as Dandenong, Epping and Millers Junction, have stronger multicultural and language-based programming opportunities. Other locations, such as Traralgon, Waurin Ponds and Chirnside Park, are more mainstream, family-oriented or regional in their audience profile.

This comparison is useful because a single programming strategy is unlikely to suit every Reading Cinemas location in Victoria. Each cinema should continue to support mainstream releases, but the level of opportunity for language films, community

screenings, youth-focused releases, family programming and premium experiences varies by location.

### Comparative Audience and Programming Summary

| Reading Cinemas Location | Local Audience Character                                                                         | Strongest Programming Direction                                                                                                         |
|--------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Burwood                  | Established inner-eastern catchment with strong multicultural and family segments.               | Mainstream films, Chinese-language films, family films, premium sessions and selected South Asian or community screenings.              |
| Chirnside Park           | Outer-eastern suburban catchment with strong family and mainstream audience profile.             | Mainstream releases, family films, school holiday programming, mature-audience films and selective international screenings.            |
| Dandenong                | Highly multicultural south-eastern catchment with strong language diversity.                     | Multicultural programming, Vietnamese films, Chinese-language films, South Asian films, family films and community screenings.          |
| Epping                   | Large northern growth-corridor catchment with strong family and multicultural communities.       | South Asian films, Arabic/Middle Eastern films, family programming, mainstream blockbusters and selected European community screenings. |
| Melton                   | Western growth-corridor catchment with young families and growing multicultural communities.     | Family films, mainstream releases, South Asian films, Vietnamese films, Arabic/Middle Eastern films and selected community screenings.  |
| Millers Junction         | Inner-west and western catchment with a mixed lifestyle, family and multicultural audience base. | Mainstream films, South Asian films, Chinese-language films, Vietnamese films, premium sessions and community screenings.               |
| Sunbury                  | North-western family-focused catchment with a growing multicultural audience base.               | Mainstream films, family programming, school holiday releases and                                                                       |

|              |                                                                                                           |                                                                                                                            |
|--------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|              |                                                                                                           | selective South Asian, Arabic or Turkish films.                                                                            |
| Traralgon    | Regional Latrobe Valley and Gippsland catchment with a strong Australian-born and older audience profile. | Mainstream releases, family films, Australian films, mature-audience films, local-interest content and event cinema.       |
| Waurin Ponds | Geelong and Surf Coast regional-city catchment with family, youth and student audiences.                  | Mainstream films, family releases, youth-focused films, Australian films, anime/event cinema and selective language films. |

## Language and Cultural Programming Opportunity Heatmap

| Programming Opportunity                     | Burwood   | Chirnside Park | Dandenong | Epping    | Melton    | Millers Junction | Sunbury   | Traralgon | Waurin Ponds |
|---------------------------------------------|-----------|----------------|-----------|-----------|-----------|------------------|-----------|-----------|--------------|
| Chinese-language films                      | Strong    | Selective      | Strong    | Moderate  | Selective | Strong           | Selective | Limited   | Moderate     |
| Vietnamese films                            | Selective | Limited        | Strong    | Moderate  | Moderate  | Strong           | Limited   | Limited   | Selective    |
| South Asian films                           | Moderate  | Selective      | Strong    | Strong    | Strong    | Strong           | Moderate  | Limited   | Moderate     |
| Arabic / Middle Eastern films               | Limited   | Selective      | Strong    | Strong    | Moderate  | Moderate         | Moderate  | Limited   | Selective    |
| Greek / Italian community screenings        | Moderate  | Selective      | Moderate  | Moderate  | Selective | Moderate         | Selective | Selective | Selective    |
| Filipino / Tagalog community screenings     | Limited   | Limited        | Moderate  | Selective | Moderate  | Moderate         | Moderate  | Limited   | Selective    |
| Korean / Japanese event cinema and anime    | Moderate  | Selective      | Selective | Selective | Selective | Moderate         | Limited   | Limited   | Moderate     |
| Family films and school holiday programming | Strong    | Strong         | Strong    | Strong    | Strong    | Strong           | Strong    | Strong    | Strong       |
| Mature-audience and daytime programming     | Moderate  | Strong         | Selective | Selective | Selective | Selective        | Selective | Strong    | Moderate     |
| Premium / date-night programming            | Strong    | Moderate       | Selective | Moderate  | Selective | Strong           | Selective | Limited   | Moderate     |

### Heatmap Guide

| Level     | Meaning                                                                                  |
|-----------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Strong    | Clear programming opportunity based on catchment demographics and audience scale.        |
| Moderate  | Meaningful opportunity, but best tested through selected sessions or targeted campaigns. |
| Selective | Smaller opportunity that may work for the right release, event or community campaign.    |
| Limited   | Not a primary programming focus, but could be considered for special cases.              |

Note: Ratings are planning indicators based on catchment demographics. They should be validated through distributor availability, local marketing and actual ticket sales performance.

## Key Comparative Insights

Dandenong, Epping and Millers Junction appear to have the strongest opportunity for regular multicultural programming because their catchments have larger and more diverse language and country-of-birth profiles. These locations should be prioritised for testing language films, community screenings and targeted local marketing.

Burwood has a particularly strong opportunity for Chinese-language cinema, supported by the strength of Mandarin and broader Chinese community indicators across its catchment. It should also maintain a balanced program of mainstream, family, premium and selected international films.

Chirnside Park, Traralgon and Waurm Ponds should remain more mainstream-led. These locations can still support selected international or event-style screenings, but their strongest programming direction is likely to remain mainstream releases, family films, school holiday programming, Australian films and mature-audience titles.

Melton and Sunbury sit between these two groups. Both are family-heavy growth-corridor locations with growing multicultural communities. They should remain mainstream and family-led, while testing selected South Asian, Arabic, Filipino, Turkish or European community films through limited sessions and targeted local promotion.

Overall, the comparison shows that Reading Cinemas Victoria would benefit from a location-aware programming strategy. Mainstream releases remain important across every cinema, but language films, community screenings, youth-focused releases and premium experiences should be tailored to the demographic profile of each local catchment.

## 7. Language and Cultural Programming Opportunities

The demographic profiles show that language and cultural programming opportunities are not evenly spread across all Reading Cinemas Victoria locations. Some cinemas have strong multicultural catchments that may support more regular testing of language films, while others are better suited to selective community screenings or event-based releases.

Language programming should not be treated as a replacement for mainstream film programming. Mainstream releases remain important across all locations. However, selected non-English language films, community screenings, subtitled releases and event cinema can help Reading Cinemas better serve local communities and increase relevance in specific catchments.

The strongest language and cultural programming opportunities are likely to sit in locations with larger multicultural populations, higher levels of language diversity and clear community concentration across the wider catchment. These include Dandenong, Epping, Millers Junction, Burwood, Melton and selected opportunities in Sunbury and Waurm Ponds.

### Language and Cultural Programming Opportunities

| Programming Opportunity | Strongest Locations                  | Programming Direction                                                                  |
|-------------------------|--------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Chinese-language films  | Burwood, Dandenong, Millers Junction | Test Mandarin and Cantonese-language releases, especially for major Chinese, Hong Kong |



|                                                  |                                                   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
|--------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                                                  |                                                   | or broader Asian cinema titles. Burwood is a particularly strong opportunity because of the size of its Mandarin-speaking catchment.                                                                                                              |
| South Asian films                                | Dandenong, Epping, Melton, Millers Junction       | Test Hindi, Punjabi, Tamil, Telugu, Malayalam, Urdu, Nepali, Gujarati, Bengali and Sinhalese-related releases depending on distributor availability. Epping, Dandenong, Melton and Millers Junction appear especially relevant for this category. |
| Vietnamese films                                 | Dandenong, Millers Junction                       | Consider selected Vietnamese-language films or community-targeted screenings, particularly in catchments where Vietnamese language and ancestry indicators are stronger.                                                                          |
| Arabic and Middle Eastern films                  | Epping, Dandenong, Melton, Sunbury                | Test selected Arabic-language or Middle Eastern community films where release strength and local marketing support are available. Epping and Dandenong appear to have the strongest opportunity in this category.                                 |
| Greek, Italian and European community screenings | Burwood, Epping, Millers Junction, Chirnside Park | Consider selected Greek, Italian, Macedonian, Croatian, Serbian or broader European community screenings for suitable releases or cultural event periods. These should be event-led rather than regular programming unless demand is proven.      |
| Filipino / Tagalog community screenings          | Millers Junction, Melton, Sunbury, Dandenong      | Test selected Filipino or Tagalog-language films as                                                                                                                                                                                               |

|                                               |                                                      |                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
|-----------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                                               |                                                      | limited screenings where community interest and local promotion can support attendance.                                                                                                                            |
| Korean and Japanese event cinema              | Burwood, Millers Junction, Waurin Ponds              | Consider Korean cinema, Japanese anime, concert films, fan-event screenings and limited-run international releases, especially in locations with younger audiences or strong event-cinema potential.               |
| Family and multicultural community screenings | Dandenong, Epping, Melton, Millers Junction, Sunbury | Use family-friendly language films, weekend sessions and school holiday periods to test community-based programming. Larger family households may support stronger group attendance for culturally relevant films. |
| Regional and local-interest programming       | Traralgon, Waurin Ponds                              | Prioritise Australian films, mainstream releases, regional stories, mature-audience films, event cinema and selected international films rather than heavy language-film programming.                              |

### Programming Approach

The best approach is to treat language and cultural programming as a test-and-learn opportunity. Reading Cinemas should not assume that a demographic group will automatically attend a film because of language or cultural background. Instead, demographic data should be used to identify where a film may have stronger local relevance, and then performance should be measured through ticket sales, occupancy, repeat demand and customer response.

For high-opportunity locations such as Dandenong, Epping and Millers Junction, Reading Cinemas could consider more regular testing of selected language films. For moderate or selective-opportunity locations such as Burwood, Melton, Sunbury and

Waurin Ponds, language films may work best as limited sessions, weekend screenings, festival-style programming or community-supported releases.

Local marketing will be important. Language films and community screenings are more likely to succeed when supported by targeted social media, local community outreach, culturally relevant messaging, cinema signage and partnerships with community groups where appropriate.

Overall, the analysis suggests that Reading Cinemas Victoria has an opportunity to use demographic insight to make language and cultural programming more location-aware. Rather than applying the same programming approach across every cinema, Reading Cinemas can tailor selected international films, language releases and community screenings to the catchments where they are most likely to be relevant.

## 8. Programming Recommendations by Cinema

The demographic analysis suggests that Reading Cinemas Victoria should use a location-aware programming approach. All nine locations should continue to support mainstream film releases, but selected cinemas have stronger opportunities for language films, community screenings, family programming, youth-focused films, premium sessions and event cinema.

The recommendations below translate the demographic findings into practical programming directions for each cinema location. These recommendations should be treated as planning opportunities and should be tested through ticket sales, local marketing performance, session occupancy and customer response.

### Programming Recommendations by Cinema

| Reading Cinemas Location | Local Audience Opportunity                                                                                                                      | Suggested Programming Focus                                                                                                                                  | Recommended Testing Approach                                                                                                                                                                    |
|--------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Burwood</b>           | Established inner-eastern catchment with strong Chinese-language indicators, family households, mature audiences and premium-session potential. | Mainstream releases, Mandarin and Cantonese-language films, selected South Asian films, family films, premium/date-night sessions and mature-audience films. | Test Chinese-language films more deliberately, especially Mandarin releases. Use selected sessions for South Asian, Korean, Vietnamese, Greek or Italian community films where demand is clear. |
| <b>Chirnside Park</b>    | Outer-eastern suburban                                                                                                                          | Mainstream releases, family                                                                                                                                  | Keep programming mainstream-led. Test                                                                                                                                                           |

|                         |                                                                                                                             |                                                                                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                                                                                          |
|-------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                         | catchment with a strong Australian-born, family and mature-audience profile.                                                | films, school holiday programming, mature-audience films, Australian films and selected international screenings.                                                     | international or language films through limited sessions only when the release has clear local appeal.                                                                                   |
| <b>Dandenong</b>        | Highly multicultural south-eastern catchment with strong language diversity and family/community audience potential.        | Vietnamese films, Chinese-language films, South Asian films, Sri Lankan, Cambodian/Khmer, Arabic, Turkish, Persian and selected European community screenings.        | Treat Dandenong as a priority location for multicultural programming. Test language films with stronger visibility, targeted local marketing and weekend/community-friendly sessions.    |
| <b>Epping</b>           | Large northern growth-corridor catchment with strong family, South Asian, Middle Eastern and European community indicators. | South Asian films, Arabic/Middle Eastern films, Italian, Greek and Macedonian community screenings, family films, mainstream blockbusters and youth-focused releases. | Program selected language films more deliberately, especially South Asian and Arabic/Middle Eastern releases. Use weekend sessions, family-friendly times and local community promotion. |
| <b>Melton</b>           | Western growth-corridor catchment with young families, working-age households and growing multicultural communities.        | Family films, school holiday releases, mainstream blockbusters, South Asian films, Vietnamese films, Arabic/Middle Eastern films and Filipino community screenings.   | Keep family and mainstream programming central. Test South Asian and selected community films through limited sessions and targeted local marketing.                                     |
| <b>Millers Junction</b> | Mixed inner-west and western catchment with multicultural, family, lifestyle and premium audience segments.                 | Mainstream releases, South Asian films, Chinese-language films, Vietnamese films, premium/date-                                                                       | Use a balanced programming strategy. Test language films and premium/event sessions across weekends and                                                                                  |

|                     |                                                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                                                     |                                                                                                                                                                |
|---------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                     |                                                                                                                  | night sessions, Filipino, Greek, Italian and Middle Eastern community screenings.                                                                                                   | evenings, supported by localised promotion.                                                                                                                    |
| <b>Sunbury</b>      | North-western family-focused catchment with a strong mainstream base and growing multicultural audience.         | Mainstream releases, family films, school holiday programming, South Asian films, Arabic/Middle Eastern films, Turkish films and selected Filipino or Pacific community screenings. | Keep programming mainstream and family-led. Test language films selectively through limited weekend sessions.                                                  |
| <b>Traralgon</b>    | Regional Latrobe Valley and Gippsland catchment with strong Australian-born, older and family audience profiles. | Mainstream releases, Australian films, family films, mature-audience films, regional/local-interest content, comedy, drama and event cinema.                                        | Keep programming regionally focused and mainstream-led. Use selected international or community screenings only where there is clear demand.                   |
| <b>Waurin Ponds</b> | Geelong and Surf Coast regional-city catchment with family, youth, student and mature-audience segments.         | Mainstream releases, family films, Australian films, youth-focused films, anime/event cinema, mature-audience films and selected Chinese or South Asian films.                      | Prioritise mainstream, family and youth/event programming. Test anime, Japanese event cinema, Chinese-language and South Asian films through limited sessions. |

### Overall Programming Direction

The strongest multicultural programming opportunities appear to be at **Dandenong, Epping and Millers Junction**. These cinemas should be prioritised for testing language films, community screenings and culturally targeted local marketing.

**Burwood** has a strong opportunity for Chinese-language films, especially Mandarin-language releases, while also supporting premium sessions, family films and mature-audience programming.

**Melton and Sunbury** should remain family and mainstream-led, but both have growing multicultural catchments that may support selected South Asian, Arabic, Filipino, Turkish or European community films.

**Chirnside Park, Traralgon and Waurin Ponds** should remain more mainstream-led. These locations can still support selected international, event or community screenings, but their strongest opportunities are likely to sit in family films, mature-audience films, Australian films, youth/event cinema and broad commercial releases.

Overall, Reading Cinemas should avoid using the same programming strategy across all Victorian locations. A location-aware approach would allow each cinema to maintain strong mainstream programming while testing language films, community screenings and event cinema where the local audience profile supports stronger opportunity.

## 9. Risks and Considerations

Demographic data can help Reading Cinemas identify local audience patterns and potential programming opportunities, but it should be used carefully. The presence of a language group, ancestry group or cultural community within a cinema catchment does not automatically guarantee demand for a particular film. Demographics should be treated as a planning signal, not a fixed prediction of audience behaviour.

Programming decisions should also consider film availability, distributor rights, release timing, marketing support, previous ticket sales, session performance and local audience response. The strongest approach is to use demographic insight to identify opportunities, then test those opportunities through selected sessions, targeted promotion and performance measurement.

### Key Risks and Considerations

| Risk or Consideration          | Why It Matters                                                                                                  | Recommended Approach                                                                                         |
|--------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Demographic overgeneralisation | Not every person from a language or cultural background will want to watch films from that language or culture. | Use demographic data as a guide only, not as a fixed assumption about audience behaviour.                    |
| Stereotyping audience groups   | Poorly framed recommendations could make the report feel insensitive or overly simplistic.                      | Use professional language such as “programming opportunity”, “local audience signal” and “potential demand”. |

|                                          |                                                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                   |
|------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Film availability and distributor rights | Reading Cinemas may not have access to every language or international film suggested by the demographic analysis. | Match recommendations with distributor availability and realistic release schedules.                                              |
| Limited demand for some language films   | A language group may exist in the catchment, but the audience may not be large enough to support regular sessions. | Test through limited sessions, weekend screenings or event-based programming before expanding.                                    |
| Marketing dependency                     | Language and community films may underperform if local audiences are not aware they are screening.                 | Support selected releases with targeted local marketing, social media, community outreach and cinema signage.                     |
| Catchment overlap                        | Some suburbs may be within reach of more than one cinema or competing cinema chain.                                | Treat catchment areas as practical audience zones, not fixed boundaries.                                                          |
| Data timing                              | The analysis uses 2021 Census data, and local populations may have changed since then.                             | Use Census data as a baseline and update insights with ticket sales, local demand and newer population trends where available.    |
| Session timing risk                      | Even relevant films may underperform if scheduled at unsuitable times.                                             | Test different session times, especially weekend, evening and community-friendly time slots.                                      |
| Commercial performance uncertainty       | Demographic fit does not always translate into ticket sales.                                                       | Track occupancy, revenue, repeat demand, booking patterns and customer feedback.                                                  |
| Mainstream programming balance           | Over-prioritising niche programming could reduce availability for mainstream releases.                             | Maintain mainstream programming as the base schedule and add targeted language or community films where opportunity is strongest. |

## Overall Consideration

The recommendations in this report should be used as a starting point for smarter local programming, not as final programming rules. Demographic insight can help Reading Cinemas identify where certain films, languages or cinema experiences may be more

relevant, but final decisions should be validated through audience demand and commercial performance.

The safest and most practical approach is to use a test-and-learn model. Reading Cinemas can trial selected language films, community screenings and event cinema in the most relevant locations, measure customer response and then expand only where demand is proven.

## **10. Conclusion**

This report shows that Reading Cinemas' nine Victorian locations operate within very different local audience catchments. While mainstream film programming remains important across every cinema, the demographic profiles suggest that each location has different opportunities based on local population size, age profile, household structure, country of birth, ancestry and language spoken at home.

The analysis highlights that locations such as Dandenong, Epping and Millers Junction have stronger multicultural and language-based programming opportunities. These cinemas may be suitable for more deliberate testing of South Asian films, Chinese-language films, Vietnamese films, Arabic or Middle Eastern community films and selected cultural screenings. Burwood also presents a strong opportunity for Chinese-language cinema, especially Mandarin-language releases, while Melton and Sunbury show growing potential for selected South Asian, Arabic, Filipino, Turkish and European community programming.

Other locations, such as Chirnside Park, Traralgon and Waurin Ponds, are better suited to a more mainstream-led approach. These cinemas should continue to focus on major releases, family films, school holiday programming, Australian films, mature-audience films and event cinema. Selected international or language films can still be tested, but they should be treated as targeted opportunities rather than core programming drivers.

The key recommendation is that Reading Cinemas should avoid applying one programming approach across all Victorian locations. A location-aware strategy would allow each cinema to maintain a strong mainstream schedule while also testing language films, community screenings, youth-focused releases, premium sessions and event cinema where the local audience profile supports stronger opportunity.

Demographic data should not be used to stereotype audiences or assume guaranteed demand. Instead, it should be used as a planning tool to guide testing, local marketing and session decisions. The strongest approach is to trial selected programming opportunities, measure ticket sales and occupancy, review customer response and expand only where demand is proven.



Overall, this report provides Reading Cinemas with a practical way to better understand the communities surrounding its Victorian cinemas. By using demographic insight alongside programming judgement and performance data, Reading Cinemas can make more informed film selection decisions, improve local relevance and create stronger audience engagement across its Victorian network.